

OKAFOR, IFEANYI WILSON

Cloud Security Architect | Infrastructure Architect | DevSecOps Engineer

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SUMMARY

Senior Cloud Security and Infrastructure Architect with 15+ years of experience spanning cloud architecture, AWS infrastructure, DevOps, DevSecOps, CI/CD, application modernization, and enterprise technology delivery. Hands-on expertise designing and operating secure, highly available, scalable AWS environments supporting enterprise applications across development, disaster recovery, and production. Strong background in AWS security, IAM, Infrastructure-as-Code, CloudFormation, Terraform, Harness CI/CD, Kubernetes, EC2, ECS/Fargate, Lambda, API Gateway, EventBridge, SNS, SQS, DynamoDB, ECR, VPC, ALB, CloudWatch, and cloud observability. Experienced in security remediation, TLS/SSL configuration, vulnerability management, production troubleshooting, automation, and root-cause analysis. Proven ability to bridge enterprise architecture, cybersecurity, application engineering, and operations, translating business requirements into secure and cost-effective cloud solutions. Certified AWS Solutions Architect, CISM, CEH, and PMP.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Cloud Security & DevSecOps • AWS Security Architecture • IAM & Least Privilege • Cloud Infrastructure • Infrastructure-as-Code • CI/CD • CloudFormation • Terraform • Harness • Kubernetes/EKS • ECS/Fargate • Serverless Architecture • Cloud Networking • TLS/SSL • Vulnerability Remediation • Security Automation • Observability • Incident & Root-Cause Analysis • Application Modernization • Enterprise Architecture (Compliance and Configuration)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

United Airlines, Chicago, IL.

DevOps Engineer/Cloud Infrastructure Engineer

03/2022 - Present

- Partnered with IT architecture team and management to design, implement, maintain, and create strategies, roadmaps, solutions, infrastructure standards, and processes, in application integration & architecture modernization.
- Architected, deployed, secured, and supported highly available AWS infrastructure for enterprise applications across Dev, QA, Staging, Disaster Recovery, and Production environments.
- Implemented and maintained monitoring and alerting systems, reducing Mean Time to Resolution (MTTR) by 40% and improving system availability by 25%
- Provisioned resources for enterprise application migration, leveraging ECS Fargate, RDS, and other strategic resources Utilizing CI/CD pipeline.
- Designed and implemented a fully automated CI/CD pipeline, reducing deployments time by 50%, and increase in deployment frequency by someone to 95%
- Provide infrastructure architecture and DevOps leadership towards Modernization, Optimization and Migration efforts across multiple critical applications.
- Lead root-cause analysis for complex AWS failures involving IAM, AWS Compute Systems, Serverless Systems, Containers, TLS/SSL, Networking, EventBridge, API Gateway, and database connectivity, etc.
- Developed and automated Disaster Recovery Systems for 32 applications, with 98% reliability in traffic transfer.
- Provisioned and automated enterprise infrastructure using CloudFormation, Terraform and other IAC platforms, resulting in 42% reduction in infrastructure cost and 20% increase in system reliability.
- Support cloud-security initiatives involving IAM, TLS/SSL, HTTPS security policies, Wiz, Veracode, Invicti, and DevSecOps controls.
- Monitor, analyze, and report performance statistics for cloud hosted environments.
- Develop application performance management to measure and leverage performance data.
- Implement observability using CloudWatch, Datadog, Dynatrace, and centralized application/container logging.
- Created multiple serverless architecture, routing metadata to DBs like Aurora, Dynamo db., Postgres etc.
- Created Transaction Processor State Machines, utilizing LAMBDA to integrate Step Functions.

ESPN, Bristol, CT.

AWS Solutions Architect - Consultant

10/2019 - 03/2022

- Designed, managed, and supervised several cloud production projects, to support the strategic objectives of the Enterprise. Designed and adjusted global AWS infrastructure, including nodes in 12 regions and 39 sub-regions.
- Partner with IT architecture team and management to design, implement, maintain, and create strategies, roadmaps, solutions, infrastructure standards, and processes.
- Automated and deployed a N-tier architecture with full stack, in various operating systems.
- Created, Managed, and monitored clusters of 87 EC2 instances, behind ALBs within multiple AS groups.
- Provided assistance and expertise to management on improvements to company productivity, systems performance, high availability, monitoring, and operational costs.
- Researched, analyzed, evaluated, and provided recommendations to management on Next-Gen technology direction including but not limited to cloud services, Network, Compute, Storage, and Endpoints.
- Check health and performance of containers running inside nodes of EKS cluster using Elasticsearch cluster.
- Created and configured elastic load balancers and auto scaling groups to distribute the traffic and to have a cost efficient, fault tolerant and highly available environment.
- Creating and using REST APIs for various needs in target applications, including calling Step functions.
- Responsible for Continuous Integration (CI) and Continuous Delivery (CD) process implementation-using Jenkins; along with Python and Shell scripts to automate routine jobs.
- Managed the monitoring and alarms of production and dev. servers using CloudWatch and Datadog
- Created RDS instances to serve data requests.
- Created Transaction Processor State Machines, utilizing LAMBDA to integrate STEP FUNCTIONS.

Northrop Grumman, Los Angeles, CA

AWS Infrastructure Architect

07/2016 - 10/2019

- Lead architecture initiatives from inception to completion. Assist management and engineering staff in the evaluation, analysis, architecture, design, and implementation of enterprise infrastructure and application programs and projects.
- Migrated enterprise applications from on-premises data centers to AWS.
- Configured AWS Identity and Access Management (IAM) Groups and Users for improved login authentication. Also handled federated identity access using IAM to enable access to our AWS account.
- Led enterprise infrastructure architecture initiatives from requirements through design, implementation, and production delivery.
- Migrated enterprise applications from on-premises data centers to AWS.
- Implemented AWS IAM authentication, federated access, DNS, SSL certificates, and secure application connectivity across Dev, QA, and Production.
- Automated infrastructure and application deployment processes using AWS CLI, Bash, and Python

Microsoft Corporation, Redmond WA.

Business Analyst

03/2011 - 07/2016

- Worked independently with users to define concepts and clarify Functional and Non-Functional requirements daily.
- Facilitated the Joint Application Development (JAD) sessions with project stakeholders to capture business rules, processes, and system requirements for specific Application System.
- Led requirements analysis, architecture planning, process engineering, and technology initiatives for enterprise applications. Serving as SME for the Software Change Request Process (SCR) to effectively manage all change requests to the application.
- Facilitated JAD sessions and collaborated with business stakeholders, developers, architects, and subject-matter experts to define functional and non-functional requirements.
- Developed business requirements, technical requirements, test plans, and test cases for enterprise applications.
- Supported migration planning from legacy platforms to J2EE-based architecture and managed software change requests and configuration management. Developed and documented business requirements, technical requirements, test plans, and test cases for the Image Processing Applications (IPS).

EDUCATION

- Master of Science, Cybersecurity — American Public University | 2021

- Master of Business Administration – University of Politehnica, Bucharest | 2012
- Bachelor of Science, Computer Science – Federal University of Technology, Owerri | 2009
- Certificate, Business Analysis – Jrock Institute of Technology | 2014

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solution Architect – Associate (AWS-SA)
- Certified Information Security Manager (CISM)
- Project Management Professional (PMP)
- Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AWS Services: EC2, ECS, S3, ELB, Auto Scaling Groups, Glacier, EBS, Elastic Beanstalk, Cloud Formation/Terraform, Cloud Front, RDS, Redshift, VPC, Direct Connect, Route 53, Cloud Watch, Cloud Trail, MWAA, OpsWorks, IAM, DynamoDB, SNS, SQS, ElastiCache, RedShift, EMR, Lambda, MWAA, Kafka, Kinesis, CodePipeline, CI/CD, IaC, REST APIs

DevOps/IaC: Harness, Jenkins, Teamcity, Terraform, CloudFormation, AWS CLI, Github, CI/CD, Bash, Python, YAML, JSON

Security: AWS IAM, Least Privilege, Trust Policies, TLS/SSL, ACL, ACM, Security Groups, Wiz, Veracode, Invicti, AWS WAF, AWS Shield, VPC Endpoints, Amazon Guard Duty, Encryptions etc.

Containers / Observability: Kubernetes, Docker, EKS, ECS/Fargate, ECR, CloudWatch, Datadog, Dynatrace, Elasticsearch

Databases: RDS, DynamoDB, SQL Server, Oracle, MySQL, PostgreSQL

Operating Systems: Linux, UNIX, Ubuntu, Windows

Methodologies: Agile, DevOps, DevSecOps, SDLC, Waterfall, Infrastructure-as-Code